

Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥J

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥10

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥2

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥2

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7
 ♥ 6 4 2
 ♦ J 7 5
 ♣ Q J 9 5 3

♠ Q 9 6 5
 ♥ A Q 9 3
 ♦ K Q 8
 ♣ A 6



♠ A 4 2
 ♥ J 10 8 7
 ♦ 10 6 4 2
 ♣ K 10

♠ K J 10 3
 ♥ K 5
 ♦ A 9 3
 ♣ 8 7 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♥J			

SOUTH uses Stayman because he has a 4-card ♠ suit.

NORTH's 2♥ response wasn't exactly what SOUTH was hoping for, so SOUTH decides to bid 3NT.

NORTH absolutely knows that SOUTH holds a 4-card Major - and also knows that it isn't ♥s. So NORTH bids 4♠.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 7 4
 ♥ Q 8 6 2
 ♦ 10 8 7 6
 ♣ 4

♠ K 3 2

♥ J 9 5 3

♦ J

♣ A J 6 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10 6

♥ A K 7 4

♦ A Q 5 3

♣ 10 9

♠ Q 8 5

♥ 10

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ K Q 8 7 5

WEST has a rotten hand, and many players would just pass 1NT.

But WEST figures that having EAST play any 4-4 fit would be better than 1NT so he bids 2♣, Stayman. This is called "Garbage Stayman", and you can see why.

EAST bids 2♥ and WEST passes. He would have passed either 2♠ or 2♦ also.

West	North	East	South
		1NT	
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
All Pass			
2♥ by East			
Lead: ♥10			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 9 5
 ♥ A 7 3 2
 ♦ J 8 7 5
 ♣ J 10

♠ K J 7 3

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K 10 4

♣ Q 9 3



♠ 8 4

♥ 10 6 4

♦ Q 9 3

♣ A 6 5 4 2

♠ A Q 6 2

♥ K J 8

♦ A 6 2

♣ K 8 7

Just having a 4-card Major doesn't mean you must automatically use Stayman.

Here NORTH has a 4-card ♠ suit, but decides not to seek a 4-4 fit because his hand wouldn't have any ruffing values in a ♠ contract. He bids 3NT.

Notice that even though SOUTH also has four ♠s the 4-4 fit is not useful to them in a ♠ contract because neither hand can ruff any losers.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥2			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 7
♥ K J 5 4
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ A 5

♠ 5 3

♥ 10 8 2

♦ 9 5 2

♣ K J 9 7 2



♠ Q 10 8 6 4

♥ Q 7 3

♦ A 6

♣ 10 8 4

♠ A 9 2

♥ A 9 6

♦ J 10 8 4

♣ Q 6 3

EAST has an invitational (9 point) hand with five
♠s.

She bids it in the standard way - first transfer WEST
to ♠s, then invite the game by bidding 2NT.

WEST, with 17 points and three ♠s, accepts the
game invitation and chooses 4♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1NT	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	2NT	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by West			
Lead: ♥2			